



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

āyusmato* *apy* eṣa* vayah+(prakarṣo* Cprakarṣān*) |
niḥ+saṃśayaṃ* kāla+vaśena bhāvī |
evaṃ* jarāṃ* rūpa+vināśayitrīm* |
jānāti ca*eva*icchati (ca*eva Cca*eṣa*)lokaḥ || 3.33 |
tataḥ sa* pūrva+āśaya+śuddha+buddhir |
vistīrṇa+kalpa+ācīta+puṇya+karmā |
śrutvā jarāṃ* saṃvivije mahā+ātmā |
mahā+aśaner* ghoṣam iva*antike gauḥ || 3.34 |

— Buddhacarita, Chapter 3, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

The verses from the Buddhacarita reveal a pivotal moment in Prince Siddhartha's journey. They describe his understanding of aging, jarā, and its inevitable impact on physical beauty. The first verse speaks of the undeniable truth that even the longest lifespan progresses, ultimately succumbing to the power of time. Even though people know aging destroys beauty, they still desire worldly things. The second verse highlights Siddhartha's profound reaction to this realization. His mind, purified by lifetimes of good deeds, was deeply shaken upon hearing about old age. It was as if the roar of a great thunderclap struck him, much like a cow startled by a nearby storm.

Siddhartha's reaction wasn't merely intellectual; it was a visceral awakening. He wasn't simply acknowledging aging as a concept, but feeling its weight, its inevitability. This is vital for you to understand. Many of us intellectually grasp the transience of life, but often fail to internalize it. We get caught up in chasing youth, accumulating possessions, and building identities based on fleeting circumstances, all while ignoring the ticking clock.

The Buddhacarita invites you to reflect on your relationship with impermanence. How often do you avoid thinking about aging, sickness, and death? How much of your energy is spent clinging to things that are destined to fade? Siddhartha's example encourages you to confront these realities, not with fear or despair, but with wisdom and acceptance. By acknowledging the ephemeral nature of existence, you can cultivate a deeper appreciation for the present moment and prioritize what truly matters: compassion, inner peace, and spiritual growth. His pre-existing purity and past good deeds allowed him to be more receptive to this truth, suggesting that your own efforts toward virtue and self-awareness will prepare you for similar awakenings. The story illustrates that true wisdom isn't about escaping reality, but about embracing it fully, with all its joys and sorrows.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

If you truly accepted the impermanence of all things, how would you live your life differently today?